

Order or Payment?

Two ways to integrate. One question tells you which one is right for you, and you will not have to change your mind later.

Do you already have a system that keeps track of what your customers are buying?

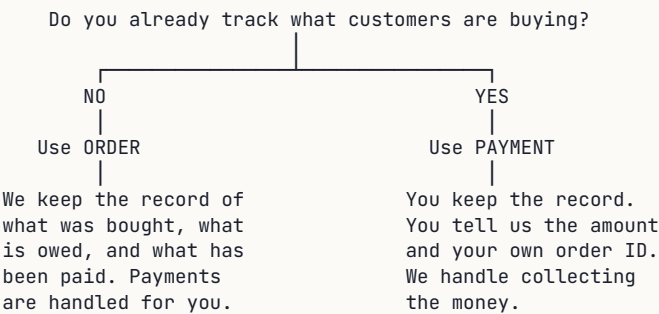
Start here

There are two ways to integrate with us, and they are not beginner and advanced versions of the same thing. They are two different answers to one question about your business.

THE ONE QUESTION

Do you already have a system that keeps track of what your customers are buying?

It might be an order management system, a point-of-sale system, an ERP, or your own custom software. If the answer is no, start with **Order**. If the answer is yes, start with **Payment**.



WHY THIS MATTERS

Picking the wrong one is not fatal, but it costs you. Choose **Order** when you already have your own system and you will end up keeping two records of the same sale in sync. Choose **Payment** when you have no system and you will end up building order tracking yourself, in a spreadsheet, badly.

If you don't have an order system, use Order

Order does the job your order system would do, and it handles the payment side for you.

What you get

YOU GET	WHICH MEANS
A record of the sale	Products, quantities, prices, discounts, tax, customer, addresses. All in one place, all searchable.
A running total	What is owed, what has been collected, what is still outstanding. Kept up to date automatically as payments come in.

YOU GET	WHICH MEANS
Split payments handled	A customer pays part on a gift card and part on a card. We do the arithmetic. You do not.
Deposits and balances	Take a deposit today and the balance in six weeks, against the same order.
Checkout in one call	Create an order, ask for a checkout page, send the link. Done.
Refunds that work out themselves	Return one item from a three-item order paid two ways, and we work out how much goes back to each.
Shipping and collection tracking	Record what has shipped, what is waiting, what came back.
Receipts and invoices	Generated for you, because you have nowhere else to generate them.
Paying other people	If you run a marketplace or a franchise, we work out who is owed what and when they get paid.

What it looks like

```

POST /orders
{
  "currency": "USD",
  "customer": { "email": "sam@example.com" },
  "line_items": [
    { "sku": "MUG-BLU", "description": "Blue mug", "quantity": 2, "unit_amount": 1800 },
    { "sku": "BEAN-250", "description": "Coffee beans 250g", "quantity": 1, "unit_amount": 1400 }
  ]
}

POST /orders/{id}/checkout

→ { "checkout_url": "https://pay.example.com/c/cs_8Kq2WdNm5Vp",
    "ledger": { "owed": 5000, "collected": 0, "open": 5000 } }
```

Two calls, and you have a working checkout. You never had to think about how the payment is collected, retried, authenticated or routed — all of that happens underneath.

A NOTE ON GROWTH

Starting with Order does not limit you. Everything the platform can do — delayed capture, retries, multiple payment methods, in-store terminals, subscriptions — works on an Order. If you later want more direct control, you can reach into the payments underneath without rebuilding anything.

If you already have an order system, use Payment

You already know what your customers bought. We should not ask you to tell us twice.

What you get

YOU GET	WHICH MEANS
No second order record	You send us an amount and your own order ID. We never ask you to recreate your order here, and there is nothing to keep in sync.
One payment, many tries	If the first attempt is declined, we try again — different route, different timing — under the same payment. Your system sees one payment, not three.
Charge now or later	Authorise at checkout and capture when you ship. Capture in parts if you ship in parts.
Payments that survive interruptions	The customer goes off to their bank to authenticate, or abandons online and finishes in a store. Same payment throughout.
Your order ID on everything	Every charge, refund, payout and settlement line carries your reference, so your finance team can match them without a reconciliation project.
See every attempt	Which route, which credential, what the issuer said, how long it took. Useful if you care about approval rates.
A running total, if you want one	Tell us the order total and we will track what has been collected against it — without holding your order.

What it looks like

```
POST /payments
{
  "amount": 32200,
  "currency": "USD",
  "order_ref": "WEB-2026-0884213",
  "payment_method": "pm_1Pr8VtLd3nKwQ5Xm",
  "confirm": true
}
```

One call. Your order ID travels with the money from here on.

If you want the running total too

```
POST /payments
{ "amount": 19000, "order_ref": "WEB-2026-0884213", "order_total": 32200, ... }

GET /ledger?order_ref=WEB-2026-0884213
→ { "owed": 32200, "collected": 19000, "open": 13200 }
```

IMPORTANT

This is a **read-only view** that we work out from the payments we processed. It is not a copy of your order, it does not hold your products, and you must never write code to keep it in step with your system. There is nothing to sync.

If you want to look closer

Every payment has attempts beneath it. You do not have to manage them, but you can read them.

```
GET /payments/{id}/attempts
→ [ { "attempt": 1, "route": "acquirer_a", "result": "declined",
      "code": "91", "latency_ms": 2841 },
      { "attempt": 2, "route": "acquirer_b", "result": "approved",
        "credential": "network_token", "latency_ms": 612 } ]
```

Side by side

	ORDER	PAYMENT
Who keeps the record of the sale	We do	You do
What you send us	Products, quantities, prices	An amount and your order ID
Calls to take a payment	Two	One
Running total of what is owed	Included	Optional, read-only
Split payments	Handled for you	Supported; you decide the amounts
Refund across several payments	Worked out for you	You choose, or we resolve it if you gave us a total
Shipping and returns tracking	Included	Stays in your system
Receipts and invoices	Generated for you	Yours to generate
Retries and routing	Automatic	Automatic
Delayed and partial capture	Yes	Yes
In-store terminals	Yes	Yes
Subscriptions and invoicing	Yes	Yes
Marketplace and franchise payouts	Yes	Yes
See individual attempts	On request	On request

THE THING TO NOTICE

The last six rows are identical.

Neither option is the limited one. Everything the platform can do is available either way. What differs is only how much you have to tell us — and that depends on what you already know.

Which one are you?

A shop, a studio, a small brand

You sell online, or over a counter, or both. You keep track of orders in your head, in a notebook, or in your email inbox. You have a website but nothing behind it that knows what an order is.

→ **USE ORDER**

A restaurant, bar or café

Your "order" is the table check, and it lives in your till or your point-of-sale system. That system already knows what was ordered.

→ **USE PAYMENT, SENDING YOUR CHECK NUMBER AS THE REFERENCE**

A retailer with warehouses and stores

You run order management software. It knows what was bought, where stock is, what has shipped and what came back. It is the system your whole business runs on.

→ **USE PAYMENT. WE WILL NEVER ASK YOU TO DUPLICATE YOUR ORDERS HERE.**

A marketplace

Buyers fill one basket from several sellers, and you need each seller paid correctly and on time. If you do not already run order software, let us hold the basket — the payouts follow from it.

→ **USE ORDER, UNLESS YOU ALREADY HAVE YOUR OWN ORDER SYSTEM**

A business billing on invoice terms

No baskets, no checkout. You raise invoices from your accounting system on 30-day terms and want to collect against them.

→ **USE PAYMENT, SENDING YOUR INVOICE NUMBER AS THE REFERENCE**

Software serving other businesses

Your customers vary. Some run sophisticated systems, some run none at all. You integrate once and choose per customer.

→ **EITHER, SET PER CUSTOMER WHEN YOU ONBOARD THEM**

Common questions

Can I change my mind later?

You can, and the work is small in one direction. Moving from Order to Payment as you grow into your own order system is straightforward — the payments already exist and already carry identifiers. Moving from Payment to Order means we start holding a record you did not previously give us, which takes more work. Most businesses never move at all.

I use Payment. Can I still have a checkout page?

Yes. You can use our hosted checkout on either option, and you can send the product list along for display without us keeping it. You do not need Order just to get a checkout page.

I use Order. Am I giving up control?

No. You can reach into the payments beneath an order whenever you need to — to capture later, to look at attempts, to refund a specific payment. Most businesses never need to.

Do I need a different setup for my stores and my website?

No, and you should not have one. You pick once, and it applies everywhere you sell — website, app, stores, terminals, payment links, phone orders. A customer who starts online and finishes in a store is the same order and the same payment throughout.

What if I have no orders at all?

Some businesses do not. Donations, top-ups, deposits and account funding have an amount but no basket. Use Payment and send whatever reference makes sense to you, or none.

What is an "attempt" and do I need to care?

When we try to collect money, that is an attempt. If it is declined we may try again a different way. Those are separate attempts against the same payment, which is why a retry never charges your customer twice. You can look at them if you want to; you never have to.

I run a franchise or a marketplace. Does that change the answer?

No. Paying other parties works on both options. The question is still only whether you already keep a record of what customers are buying.

STILL NOT SURE?

Ask yourself where the list of what the customer is buying lives **today**. If it lives in software you already run — order management, point of sale, ERP, your own build — use Payment. If the honest answer is that it lives in a spreadsheet, an inbox or somebody's head, use Order.